

with the cake, to “cut” it. A few minutes later, have them reappear with pieces of cake, and no one will ever know you swapped it out. Seriously.

DECORATIONS

30. Accessorize your flowers with bouquets from a club or warehouse store

These stores sell bouquets with great colors, year-round. Purchasing flowers here for pew decorations, centerpieces, and buffet tables can save you a bundle.

31. See if your church or reception hall has decorations you can use

Often, people leave their decorations behind and a church or hall will save them. You may not love them (ask me about the hideous lace bows—I dare you), but they just might do, either if you get in a pinch, you just don’t care anymore, or you don’t want to spend anything else.

32. Ask your friends (tulle, anyone?)

As my friends have gotten married, they’ve passed around these two plastic garbage bags of tulle. We’ve

all used it at our weddings, and it still looks great. By the way, wrinkles easily steam out of tulle.

33. Shop creatively

I “designed” my centerpieces in a discount craft store. Twenty each of table mirrors, hurricanes, blue glass pebbles, white candles, and 5 lbs. of dried lavender, all for less than one fully-designed piece. You just can’t beat that.

34. Buy in bulk

Often, if you buy at least some minimum number, you get a discount. Hence, the above savings.

35. Give your centerpieces away

An easy way to save on prizes for reception games or gifts for your volunteers. Now, I wish I’d thought of it before the wedding.

36. Find out if your church or reception hall has a relationship with a local florist

Often, players in the wedding industry hook up to create package deals, or one will give you a discount if they know you’re using the other. It didn’t